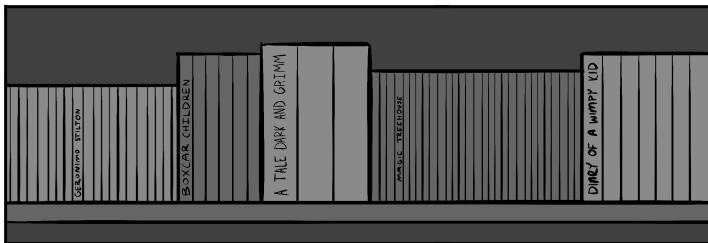


reading is
hard.

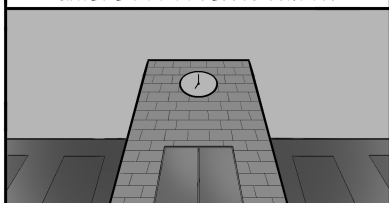
by spencer

WHEN I
WAS
YOUNG,
I LOVED
TO
READ.

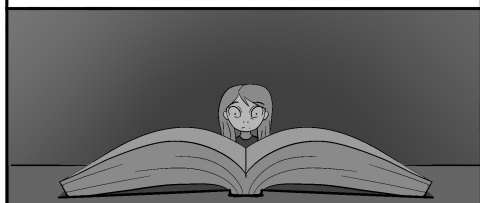


I LOVED
GORE,
ADVENTURE,
MYSTERY,
AND FANTASY
BOOKS.

UNTIL I GOT TO MIDDLE SCHOOL.



AND READING GOT HARDER.

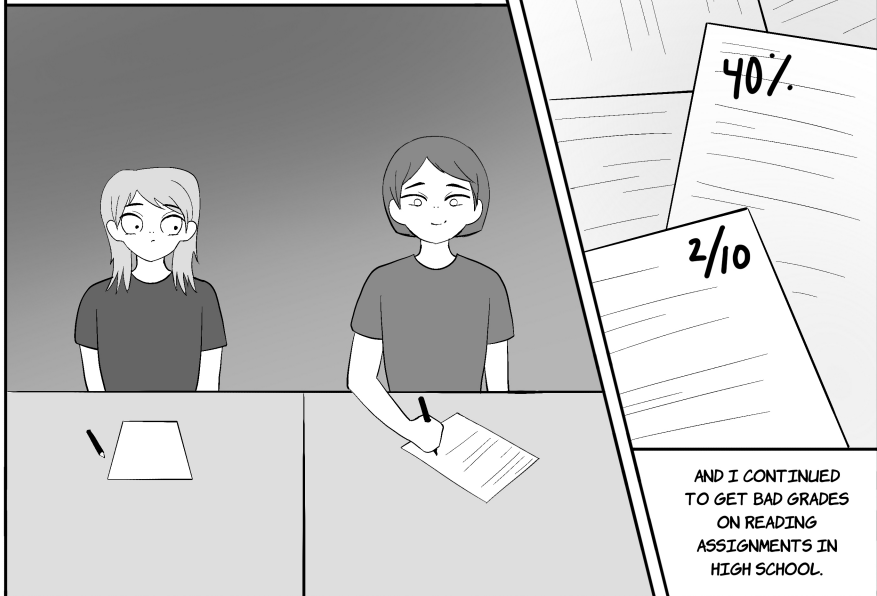


MY TEACHER DISCOURAGED ME FROM TAKING 8TH GRADE HONORS ENGLISH.



YOU'RE
NOT
READY.

BUT I TOOK IT ANYWAYS TO STAY WITH MY FRIENDS...



BURN THEM ALL..



UNTIL I DISCOVERED JUNJI ITO'S *LIZUMAKI*.



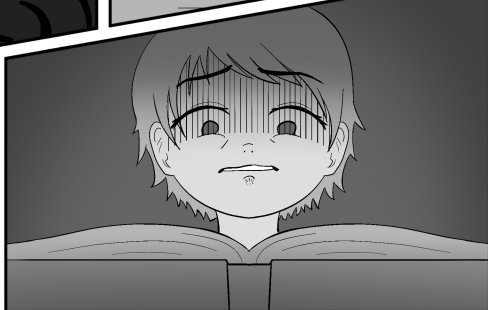
AND I STARTED TO READ MORE MANGA.



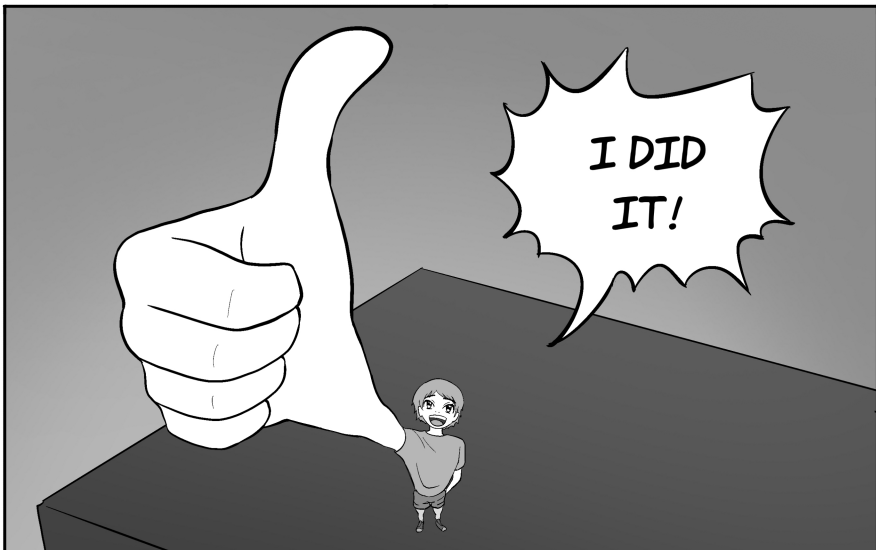
BOOKS...



BUT I WANTED TO FEEL SMARTER... SO I DECIDED TO TRY READING A NOVEL AGAIN.



IT WAS STILL HARD.



BUT IT WAS A WORTHWHILE STORY. FINISHING IT FELT LIKE ONE SMALL STEP AWAY FROM THE STRUGGLES OF THE PAST, AND TOWARDS A FUTURE WHERE I HAVE CONFIDENCE IN MY ABILITIES AS A READER. I OWE MYSELF THANKS FOR GIVING IT ANOTHER SHOT.

reading
isn't so bad.

by spencer